Ship Thesis: Image Template Spec v1

Draft v1 · November 2, 2026 · Replaces section 9 of the Blog Automation Spec

1. What this covers

One image system for every blog and every block. Each page gets three images from the same illustration: a plain illustration, a link-preview image and a LinkedIn image. The style is inspired by one reference (section 2) and must not copy it.

2. Style: soft-gradient flat vector illustration

The reference is a row of blog cards. Each card shows two or three people working around a large monitor on a pale lavender-to-white gradient, with a small badge on the screen and a pill-shaped category tag above the card title.

What we take

- The soft lavender-to-white gradient background.
- Flat vector shapes with light shading and no outlines.
- A small team around one large screen as the focal point.
- A small badge or icon on the screen that hints at the topic.
- A pill-shaped category tag.
- Rounded corners and plenty of white space.

What we do not copy

- No composition, character or scene from the reference.
- No Flutter logo or any other third-party brand mark. Use generic phone, code and diagram shapes instead.
- No text baked into the illustration. Text is added later in the HTML template.

3. Outputs for every page

Asset	Size	Text on the image	Used for
A. Illustration	1600×900 (16:9)	None	Blog index card and blog header
B. Link preview	1200×630	Pill tag, headline, wordmark, domain	Open Graph and link previews
C. LinkedIn	1200×627 and 1080×1080	Same as B	LinkedIn posts

On the blog index, the pill tag and title are real HTML on the card, not part of image A.

4. Design tokens (starting values)

Antigravity must first read the site's existing colors and fonts and match the brand where they exist. Use these values only where the site has none.

Token	Value	Use
background	#FFFFFF	Canvas
gradient-start	#EEF0FF	Top of the soft gradient
gradient-end	#FFFFFF	Bottom of the soft gradient
navy	#1B2A4E	Headline text, dark shapes
blue	#3B5BDB	Primary shapes
periwinkle	#7C8CF5	Secondary shapes
lavender	#C9CFFF	Soft background shapes
pill-bg	#EEF2FF	Category tag background
pill-text	#4F5BD5	Category tag text
muted	#5B6785	Footer text

Fonts: Inter or Plus Jakarta Sans (weight 800 for headlines, 500 for other text), with a system sans-serif fallback. Embed the font file locally so the renderer never falls back.

5. Layout of the link-preview and LinkedIn images (B and C)

- Canvas 1200×630, white background, 64px margins.
- **Left, about 55%:** pill tag at the top, headline in the middle, wordmark and domain at the bottom.
- **Right, about 45%:** the illustration inside a rounded panel (24px corners) with the soft gradient.
- **Headline:** at most 8 words over 2 to 3 lines, 64px, weight 800, line height 1.1, navy, sentence case.
- **Pill tag:** 22px text, fully rounded. Categories: MVP, SaaS, Mobile, AI, Contracts, BLOCK.
- **Footer:** "Ship Thesis" on the left, shipthesis.com on the right, 24px, muted color.
- **Square (1080×1080):** illustration on the top 58%, then the pill tag, then the headline at 56px, then the footer.
- The headline must stay readable when the image is shown 300px wide.

```
<div class="canvas">
  <div class="text">
    <span class="pill">{{category}}</span>
    <h1>{{headline}}</h1>
    <div class="footer"><span>Ship Thesis</span><span>shipthesis.com</span>
</div>
  </div>
  <div class="art"><img src="{{illustration}}" alt="{{alt}}"></div>
</div>
```

6. Illustration rules (the style lock)

- Flat vector look with soft gradients and subtle shading. No outlines, no 3D, no photo realism.
- Two or three people at most, with one large screen as the focal point.
- Colors only from the tokens in section 4.
- No text, letters, numbers or logos inside the illustration.
- Generous empty space at the edges, so the image crops cleanly in every size.
- One small topic hint on the screen, drawn with generic shapes.
- Characters are generic and must not resemble anyone on the team or any real person.

7. Character kit (keeps the series consistent)

Four fixed archetypes with no names. A scene uses two or three of them. Keep their clothing colors the same on every image.

- **Founder:** navy blazer over a white shirt.
- **Developer:** blue shirt or hoodie, with a laptop.
- **Designer:** lavender sweater, with a tablet or sketches.
- **Product lead:** white shirt, holding a phone or clipboard.

Mix genders and skin tones naturally across scenes.

8. Scene library

Page	Scene on the screen
How milestone payments work	Three-step checklist with three simple milestone icons
What to cut from v1	A phone wireframe with items being crossed out
Code ownership	A repository icon next to a lock and shield
Weekly working builds	A person holding a phone with a working app and a week calendar
Fixed scope vs hourly billing	A balance scale with a document on one side and a clock on the other
Flutter vs React Native	Two phones side by side showing one shared code panel
Deterministic AI engineering	A document turning into a clean table with a check mark
Figma to production	A design canvas on one screen and a phone build on the next
SaaS architecture stack	A simple layered stack diagram
How to vet software studios	A checklist with a magnifying glass
Blocks (all)	**No people.** A clean diagram panel on the same gradient with the BLOCK tag

9. Generation prompt (use as written)

Base prompt

> Flat vector illustration, modern tech startup style, soft lavender-to-white gradient background, {SCENE}, two or three generic characters in navy, blue, periwinkle and lavender clothing, clean shapes, subtle shading, no outlines, limited palette of navy, blue, periwinkle, lavender and white, 16:9, generous empty space around the edges, no text, no logos, no watermark.

Negative prompt

> photorealistic, 3D render, text, letters, numbers, logos, brand marks, watermark, outlines, harsh shadows, busy background, distorted hands, extra fingers, real people, celebrity likeness.

Settings: 16:9. Generate 3 candidates and keep the best one. If the tool accepts a style reference image, use the approved sample from section 12.

Blocks do not use this prompt. They are drawn as diagrams in the HTML template.

10. Pipeline for `blog:image <slug>`

1. Look up the page's scene in the scene library and build the prompt from section 9.
2. Generate 3 candidates and save the chosen one as `/public/covers/<slug>-illustration.png` and a `.webp` copy.
3. Save the prompt, settings and seed in `/public/covers/<slug>.json` so the image can be reproduced.
4. Render images B and C from the HTML template with a script (for example Playwright), using the illustration, headline and category.
5. Compress the link-preview image to under 300 KB.
6. Write alt text in the form: "Illustration of {scene} for {headline}."
7. Mark the page "image needs review" until the check in section 11 passes.

Fallback if image generation is not available: use a small library of 8 approved illustrations reused by topic, or the gradient-only layout with a diagram.

11. Image check (about one minute)

- Hands and faces look normal, with no extra fingers or distorted features.
- No stray text, numbers or logos anywhere in the illustration.
- It looks like it belongs to the same set as the other images (palette and character clothing).
- The headline is readable at 300px wide and has enough contrast.
- The headline has at most 8 words and no price or numeric timeline.
- File size and alt text are correct.

12. Approval and freeze

Generate sample sets for four pages: How milestone payments work, What to cut from v1, Weekly working builds, and one block (Next.js and Supabase auth). Adiya picks the version to keep. Then freeze it as `template-v1`: the tokens, the layout, the prompt, the character kit and the scene library. Any later change needs a version bump to `template-v2`.

13. Rules that never change

- No prices, price words or numeric delivery timelines in any headline or image.
- No team member names, and no character that resembles a real person.
- No client logos and no third-party brand marks (including the Flutter logo).
- Light/white theme only.
- No stock photos.

14. Build prompt for Antigravity (copy and paste)

> Read `/docs/image-template-spec.md` fully. It replaces section 9 of the Blog Automation Spec. Do not redesign it.
>
> First, read the site's existing colors and fonts and reconcile them with the tokens in section 4. Then build the HTML template for images B and C and the `blog:image` command. Generate the four sample sets from section 12 for my approval, and stop there. Do not generate images for any other page until I approve one version.
>
> Never put text, numbers or logos inside the illustration. Add all text in the HTML template. Save the prompt and seed for every image.

15. What Adiya decides

- Whether the site's brand colors replace the starting tokens in section 4.
- Which image generation tool Antigravity should use.
- Which of the four sample sets becomes `template-v1`.